JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Backend Engineer with three years of experience building scalable APIs and microservices for fintech and e-commerce companies. I've spent most of my career working with Python and Node.js, focusing on database optimization and payment processing integrations. I'm comfortable working independently but genuinely enjoy collaborating with frontend teams to unblock their work. Based in Birmingham and looking to grow into more complex architectural challenges.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer

FinFlow Systems

www.finflow.io

London, United Kingdom

June 2022 - Present

Developed and maintained REST APIs handling over 2 million daily transactions for a payments processing platform using Node.js and Express

Optimized PostgreSQL queries reducing average response time from 850ms to 210ms for customer dashboard endpoints

Implemented payment webhook handlers with retry logic and dead-letter queues to ensure delivery of critical financial events

Designed and deployed a currency conversion service supporting 45 currencies with real-time exchange rate updates

Mid-Level Backend Developer

TechVault Ltd

www.techvault.co.uk

Birmingham, United Kingdom

January 2021 - May 2022

Built multiple Python microservices using Flask and SQLAlchemy for an e-commerce platform serving 500k users monthly

Refactored legacy monolithic order processing system into event-driven architecture using RabbitMQ reducing processing time by 40 percent

Implemented comprehensive logging and monitoring using ELK stack to identify and resolve performance bottlenecks

Collaborated with DevOps team to establish database backup and recovery procedures meeting GDPR compliance requirements

Junior Backend Developer

DataStream Solutions

www.datastream.net

Coventry, United Kingdom

August 2019 - December 2020

Developed backend features for a data analytics platform using Python and Django REST framework

Built ETL pipelines to ingest and transform data from various third-party APIs into our PostgreSQL data warehouse

Created automated test suites achieving 78 percent code coverage and established testing standards for the team

Participated in on-call support rotation responding to production incidents within SLA timeframes

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

2016 - 2019

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript, Node.js, SQL

Frameworks and Libraries: Express.js, Django, Flask, SQLAlchemy

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis

Message Queues: RabbitMQ, Apache Kafka

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, AWS (EC2, RDS, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD

APIs and Protocols: REST, GraphQL, JSON, HTTP

Tools and Platforms: Git, GitLab CI/CD, Postman, Linux, Jira

Other: Agile methodologies, System design, API documentation, Payment processing